

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 784

By Capley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Jimmy Jones McClain.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Jimmy Jones McClain; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McClain was a highly respected member of his community and a consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Jimmy McClain was born on August 20, 1931, to Felix Martin McClain and Minnie Johnson McClain; one of eight children, he grew up during the Great Depression in circumstances that instilled in him a strong sense of responsibility and resilience at an early age; and

WHEREAS, following the tragic death of his father in a railroading accident, Jimmy McClain assumed significant family responsibilities from the age of eleven, a formative experience that shaped his protective nature and steadfast character throughout his life; and

WHEREAS, despite these early challenges, Mr. McClain distinguished himself as an outstanding student and athlete at Haylong High School, earning recognition as best all-around athlete, excelling in football and basketball, and being selected to attend Boys State, a tradition later continued by members of his own family; and

WHEREAS, after attending Columbia Military Academy on a football scholarship, Jimmy McClain was drafted during the Korean War, and he honorably served his country as a member of the United States Marine Corps, where his mechanical skill and reliability made him a valued company clerk; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McClain devoted many years to a successful professional career with Hooker Chemical Company, Stauffer Chemical, and Zeneca, retiring after long and faithful

service and earning the respect of coworkers and community members alike for his work ethic and integrity; and

WHEREAS, widely regarded as the person one could always call in times of need, Jimmy McClain was known throughout his community for his practical skills, calm presence in emergencies, and readiness to assist others without hesitation; and

WHEREAS, a man of deep faith, Mr. McClain was a devoted member of Mount Joy Cumberland Presbyterian Church, where he was the oldest official member of the congregation, and lived his Christian faith daily through kindness, humility, and service; and

WHEREAS, Jimmy McClain was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish his memory are his beloved wife, Marie Brady McClain; daughters, Debbie (Mickey) Allen and Lori (Mike) Waugh; grandchildren, Taylor (Anna Catherine) Allen and Anna (Kaleb) Dillard; great-grandson, Ben Dillard; expected great-grandchild, Davis Allen; and sister, Pat LeDoux; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his parents and his siblings, Malcolm McClain, Elaine Chirtel, Carmen Jones, Forrest McClain, Mack McClain, and Zula McClain; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McClain leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Jimmy Jones McClain, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. McClain.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.